UPSC CSE Mains 2027 · GS Paper II

GOVERNANCE

Civil services · Transparency · Accountability · RTI · Corruption · Lokpal

Handwritten-style notes

Built from the two Sarrthi IAS GS-2 Governance handouts.
Bracket trees · diagrams · mnemonics · PYQ tags · current affairs
Right column and left binding margin are kept blank for your own use.

Personal study edition · for printing

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Module 1 · Civil Services, Transparency, Accountability, Citizen's Charter, RTI

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START HERE: GOVERNANCE (GS-2)

✎ *Two modules, 19 topics. Read once with a pen. Use the right column for your own current affairs and value additions. Before a test, cover the recall drill at the end of each chapter.*

Source and rule: only the two Sarrthi IAS GS-2 Governance handouts. No class slides were supplied, so no teacher-ink forecast. **19 Mains PYQs (2013-2024), no Prelims PYQ.** Priority: **High** = 2+ PYQs, **Medium** = 1 or partial, **Low** = none quoted.

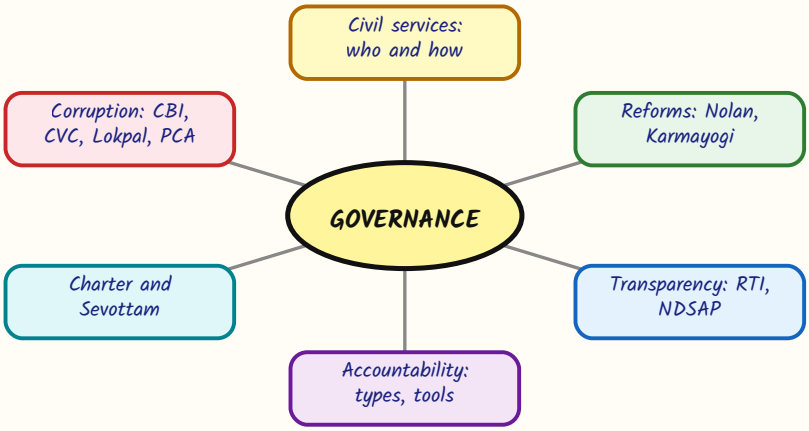
Box	Means
Pink	teacher's point / handout flag
Yellow	trap or rule for the exam hall
Green	ready conclusion
Blue dashed	definition
Navy	current affairs (verify dates)

PRIORITY MAP: what to read first

Priority	Topics (handout order)
HIGH	**8** Reforms + Nolan (2017, 2020) · **12** Citizen's Charter + Sevottam (2024, 2018, 2013) · **15** Corruption (2016, 2019, 2014) · **19** Whistleblower + PCA (2015, 2022)
MEDIUM	**2** Lateral entry (2014) · **4** Six roles (2017) · **9** Karmayogi (2020) · **11** Accountability (2016*) · **13-14** RTI + CIC (2020) · **16** Social audit (2021, 2016*) · **17** CBI + CVC (2021*) · **18** Lokpal (2013)
LOW	**1** PSCs · **3** AIS · **5** Performance · **6** Bureaucracy · **7** Pay / 8th CPC · **10** Transparency

Handout flag (source conflict): Module 1 says India got a central ombudsman in **2013**; Module 2 says Lokpal was constituted in **2019**. **Rule: "Act 2013, constituted 2019".** Mark with * a partial PYQ fit.

SIX THEMES TO TIE EVERY ANSWER TO



Answer skeleton: Intro (definition or a number) → Body (one approach: roles / problems / reforms / way forward) → Way forward (a named reform: Karmayogi, Sevottam, Lokpal…) → Conclusion ("transparency first, then accountability").

⚖ PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSIONS: UPSC & SPSC ⚖

PYQ none quoted in the material · Handout MI pp. 3-4

✎ *The Constitution set up independent recruiters for the Centre (UPSC) and the States (SPSCs). They are meant to pick the best on merit, but the shield is thinner than it looks.*

Article (Part XIV)	Provision
315	PSCs for Union and States
316	appointment and term of members
317	removal and suspension
319	bar on later office
320	functions
321	extend functions
322	expenses
323	reports

LADDER – Say it as a ladder: ***315 set up → 316 appoint → 317 remove → 319 bar → 320 functions → 321 extend → 322 expenses → 323 report*** (order kept: it is the Constitution's order). (own mnemonic)

HISTORY

1919 GoI Act: Federal PSC (provinces optional)

1924 Lee Commission recommends

1926 FPSC set up; Sir ***Ross Barker*** first chairman

1929 ***Madras***: first provincial PSC

1935 GoI Act: Federal, Provincial, Joint → Art 315

INDEPENDENCE SAFEGUARDS

Shield

→ service conditions ***cannot be cut*** after appointment
→ salaries = ***charged expenditure*** on Consolidated Fund
→ removal only as the Constitution says
→ post-retirement bar on certain government jobs
→ ***Convention:*** seniormost member becomes Chairman → ***violated in 2015***

PROBLEMS

UPSC

→ ***Advice set aside: 57 times (1950-84)*** vs ***82 (1984-88)***
→ ***Art 320(3)*** abused; influence of technical, managerial, political officials
→ no educational qualification fixed for members
→ ***Unequal status:*** one of 4 key bodies (EC, CAG, SC) yet ***no separate oath*** and ***easier removal***
→ conflict with the ***CVC***
→ ***Negative recruitment*** (screen out the unfit, not find the best); exam structure archaic

SPSCs

→ some are ***centres of corruption***
→ poor quality of members; blind copy of UPSC; like its subsidiaries
→ no formal link with UPSC

UNDONE·A — UPSC's issues: **U**nequal status · **N**o qualification · **D**eviation from advice · **O**ne-size-fits-all · **N**egative recruitment · **E**xam structure · **A**buse of 320(3) (own mnemonic)

REFORM

2nd ARC: shorten the exam

→ ***Model I:*** Prelims + Mains together over 2-3 days; Mains marked only above Prelims cut-off; then Interview

→ ***Model II:*** shortlist 2-3 × vacancies on Prelims rank; Mains within 2 months, so Mains and Interview start almost together

1st ARC on PSCs

→ one SPSC member from outside the state

→ members hold a degree

→ UPSC + SPSC chairmen consulted on SPSC members

→ ***2/3 of UPSC members*** from SPSC chairpersons

→ separate qualifications: official vs non-official members

Interview weaknesses: too short · desultory chat · artificial atmosphere · element of luck · tendency to reproduce oneself · subjectivity and bias.

Role of UPSC today

→ evolve into a ***Central Personnel Agency***

→ negative → ***positive recruitment***

→ build ***psycho-social profile*** of candidates

→ outside experts; principal ***R&D body*** in civil-service management

→ drop one-size-fits-all

In the news · Saarthi IAS CA, Jul 2026 (verify) ***Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Act, 2026:*** amends the 2024 Act; higher penalties; probe in 2 months; trial in 3 months of chargesheet; Court of Session in every State/UT; appeals to a 2-judge HC bench. ***Link:*** recruitment integrity (2nd ARC).

Recall drill: cover and answer

Part and Articles for civil services	Part XIV, Arts 308-323
First PSC and chairman	FPSC 1926, Sir Ross Barker (Lee Commission 1924)
First provincial PSC	Madras 1929
UPSC advice set aside	57 (1950-84), 82 (1984-88)
Convention broken in 2015	seniormost member as Chairman
Two 2nd ARC exam models	I: together; II: shortlist 2-3× vacancies

CIVIL SERVICES: MEANING & LATERAL ENTRY

PYQ Mains 2014 (cadre-based civil services and slow change) · Handout MI pp. 5–7

✎ *"Civil servants" are a narrower group inside "public servants". The closed, cadre-based, generalist system built for the British now needs specialists, so lateral entry is knocking.*

Origin: East India Company, about **1765**, separated combatant from non-combatant staff. **State = largest employer; ~3% of GDP** goes on civil servants.

Civil servants EXCLUDE

- → political executive
- → judiciary
- → defence forces
- → PSU employees
- → = all these are ***public servants***

Rule: all civil servants are public servants; ***not all public servants are civil servants.***

Category	Services
All India	IAS, IPS, IFoS
Central	IRS, ICAS, engineering, health, railway, para-defence (IDES, IDAS, IOFS), Secretariat
State	recruited by state
Municipal	local bodies

Groups: 3rd Pay Commission replaced Class 1–4 by **Group A, B, C, D**. A + B = management cadre; C + D = staff.

ACSM — **A**ll India · **C**entral · **S**tate · **M**unicipal (top to local) (own mnemonic)

A CLOSED "ARISTOCRATIC" SYSTEM PYQ 2014

Features

- → sharp divide between grades
- → recruitment in a narrow age band
- → tests general ability only
- → may mirror class preference
- → cadre-based services

Consequences

- → conservative, ***status quoist***, non-responsive
- → ***rule fetishism***; placement by rank not competence
- → elitist mindset; obstacles to change

CORNERS — A closed system **CORNERS** the officer: **C**onservative · **O**bstacles to change · **R**ule fetishism · **N**on-responsive · **E**litist · **R**ank not competence · **S**tatus quoist (own mnemonic)

Why social change is slow

- → education (religious and social complexes)
- → conservative attitudes, esp. towards women
- → limited social and spatial mobility
- → failure of the political system
- → ***cadre-based services + aristocratic personnel system***
- → high poverty

GENERALIST vs SPECIALIST

Generalist	Specialist
holistic policy view; coordination (2nd ARC: keep breadth, build domain expertise)	techno-economic complexity: AI, digital finance, climate, energy (NITI Aayog 3-Year Action Agenda 2017-20 → lateral entry)
grassroots field experience	policy inertia, lack of depth (2nd ARC: assign domains over a career)
institutional memory	evidence-based policy

Need for specialisation in finance, infrastructure, social, regulatory work ***after 10-12 years of service***.

LATERAL ENTRY (since 1st ARC)

Why

→ ***Type I error***: wrong person recruited
→ ***Type II error***: right person rejected
→ career path largely automatic
→ IAS built for the pre-reform State
→ Union depts need skills state cadres don't give

Issues

→ no district/field experience
→ may not see it as a career
→ corporates may place representatives; ruling party favourites
→ ***top-heavy*** administration (overstaffed top, thin field)
→ upgrade permanent staff too

2018	2021	Aug 2024	Controversy	20 Aug 2024
10 JS posts; 10 yrs, age <40; 3→5 yrs	31 posts: JS, Director, DS	45 posts (10 JS + 35 Dir/DS)	no SC/ST/OBC reservation: single posts outside roster	DoPT asks UPSC to cancel advert

Recall drill: cover and answer

Who coined "civil services", when	East India Company, c. 1765
Excluded from civil servants	political executive, judiciary, defence, PSUs
3rd Pay Commission change	Class 1-4 → Group A-D
Type I / Type II error	wrong person hired / right person rejected
Aug 2024 lateral entry	45 posts; advert cancelled 20 Aug

ALL INDIA SERVICES

PYQ none quoted in the material · Handout MI pp. 7–9

✎ *Officers recruited and trained by the Union but serving States. Patel saved them as the "Steel Frame" of unity; states now say they get responsibility without authority.*

1909	1924	1947	Today
nine AIS	four	two	three: **IAS, IPS, IFoS**

Provincialisation = abolishing an AIS. ***25 cadres***, incl. 2 joint: ***AGMUT*** (Arunachal, Goa, Mizoram, Union Territories) and ***Assam-Meghalaya***.

CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY DEBATE

Against

→ Nehru Committee Report 1928 not keen
→ regions feared Centre
→ British policy cut their number
→ ***Nehru*** not initially in favour

For: Sardar Patel

→ "***Father of AIS***" → ***Art 312***
→ states lacked capacity to recruit
→ AIS = ***Steel Frame*** of unity
→ phrase from ***David Lloyd George*** (Imperial Civil Service)

R R R R – Service Articles: ***309 Recruit · 310 Retain (pleasure) · 311 Remove (safeguards) · 312 Raise AIS***; then ***16*** equal opportunity, ***323A*** tribunals. (own mnemonic)

SHOULD AIS CONTINUE?

For (rationale)	Against (states' view)
best talent; national unity; federalism; Union touches ground realities	unity not threatened as in 1947; needs a stronger base than administration
Centre acts in emergencies; fewer political pressures on postings	***authority-responsibility mismatch***; demoralised state services
law-and-order and Centre-State coordination	***2:1 outsider-insider ratio***; "sons of the soil"; ***Entry 70, Union List***; officers spend careers in one cadre

Body	View
Rajamannar	disband AIS
Sarkaria	disbanding is retrograde; strengthen, cut generalism; Advisory Council under Cabinet Secretary; new AIS: Engineering, Medical & Health, Education

DISMISSAL AND DISCIPLINE

Doctrine of Pleasure: public job ≠ private contract. Responsive to people, responsible to government; termination subject to constitutional safeguards.

2nd ARC on Art 311

→ procedural protection makes it hard to dismiss even the deserving
→ recommends ***repeal of Art 311***
→ one comprehensive ***Civil Services Law***
→ define "reasonable opportunity"

Service rules

→ no political party, funds or elections; may vote, not disclose
→ limits on family politics, criticism of govt, media
→ annual asset declaration; report gifts

T.S.R. Subramanian (2013): minimum tenure in key posts · ***Civil Services Boards*** for postings/ transfers · avoid verbal orders · comprehensive Civil Services Law.

Recall drill: cover and answer

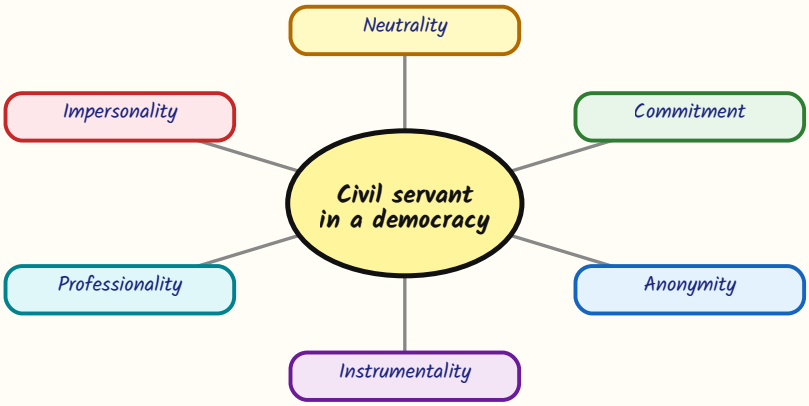
AIS count: 1909, 1924, 1947	9, 4, 2
Father of AIS; article	Sardar Patel; Art 312
AGMUT expands as	Arunachal, Goa, Mizoram, Union Territories
Sarkaria on AIS	strengthen; Advisory Council; new AIS
T.S.R. Subramanian 2013	minimum tenure, Civil Services Boards

⚖ SIX ROLES OF CIVIL SERVANTS IN A DEMOCRACY ⚖

PYQ Mains 2017 (neutrality and effectiveness) · Handout MI pp. 9–12

✎ *A civil servant must be neutral, committed, anonymous, an instrument of the people, professional and impersonal. Each role has its own pressure point.*

I PANIC — Six roles, no sequence (handout order N-C-A-I-P-I): **I**mpersonality · **P**rofessionality · **A**nonymity · **N**eutrality · **I**nstrumentality · **C**ommitment. A good officer never says "I PANIC". (own mnemonic)



1 · NEUTRALITY PYQ 2017

Three layers

→ **Class:** mostly middle class; elite capture (example: NRA, USA)
→ **Cultural:** language, caste, religion, region
→ **Political** = 3 confidences ↓

Confidence of	Meaning
People	serve whichever party they elect, diligently
Ministers	commitment irrespective of ideology
Civil servants	postings and promotions on merit, not politics

Political neutrality ≠ policy neutrality. Involvement in policy = ***intellectual, never emotional.*** Civil servants ***must understand politics, not play politics.***

Problems: a thinking person is never fully neutral · the **4Cs** of the political environment (criminalisation, casteism, communalism, corruption) · parties demand loyalty · no consensus on fundamentals · multi-party pressure at Centre and state.

Bhaskar Ghose's 3 types	Behaviour
Neither Wilt nor Tilt	firm; refuse orders against policy or law; may be transferred, stay honest
Incorrigibly Corrupt	find political godfathers early
Weather Report Readers	shift loyalty with political weather

2–6 · THE OTHER FIVE

Commitment

→ impartial rule of law; code of ethics
→ settled policies; probity; transparency; duty
→ welfare of the ***Daridra*** (poorest of the poor)

Anonymity

→ works behind the scenes; ***minister = public face***

→ credit and major failure go to the minister (***ministerial responsibility***)

→ changing: social audits, RTI, Citizens' Charters, time-bound service laws

Instrumentality

→ instrument of the people, but a full bureaucracy can become an ***independent power structure*** with elitist values

→ ***Max Weber:*** once an institution, bureaucracy is among the hardest structures to dismantle

Professionality

→ keep improving knowledge and skills

→ hindrances: generalists in specialist services · poor training (only ***1 in 5*** gets formal training; Group A, B only) · weak appraisal (no quantifiable targets) · "***hire, but no fire***" · IAS dominance

Impersonality

→ don't personalise the post (DC, SP)

→ no excess personal bonds with superiors, colleagues, juniors (example: ignoring a friend's corruption)

CIVIL SERVICES ACTIVISM

FROM ACT TO VERDICT

Forms: media · calculated leaks · courts · whistleblowing · grassroots · post-retirement (NGOs, YouTube) → *Case: Dr. Lakhina, Ahmednagar 1980s, colour-coded files by year = Lakhina Experiment* → *Issues: breaks service rules · personalises institutional issues · manipulated by parties/media · erodes credibility* → *Verdict: cannot be encouraged, but a sign of our times → reforms*

Recall drill: cover and answer

Six roles	neutrality, commitment, anonymity, instrumentality, professionality, impersonality
Three confidences	people, ministers, civil servants
Ghose's 3 types	Wilt-Tilt (firm), Incorrigibly Corrupt, Weather Report Readers
Training coverage	only 1 in 5 gets formal training
Lakhina Experiment	colour-coded files by year, Ahmednagar 1980s

WORKING & PERFORMANCE OF CIVIL SERVICES

PYQ none quoted in the material (2014 cadre PYQ printed here, answer in Ch 2) · Handout MI pp. 12–13

✎ *Civil servants formulate, implement, evaluate and adjudicate. Regulation is the best-done job; delivery and facilitation are weakest, and political meddling explains much of it.*

FIEA — Four functions: **F**ormulate · **I**mplement · **E**valuate · **A**djudicate (and keep ***continuity*** when politics changes). (own mnemonic)

Functions

→ ***Formulate:*** channel between grassroots and top; facts, court judgments, laws; draft legislation; balanced policy
→ ***Implement:*** rules, finance, HR, monitoring
→ ***Evaluate:*** feedback to leadership but conflict of interest (evaluating own programmes) → ***social audits***
→ ***Adjudicate:*** quasi-judicial (Collector revenue courts)

Function	Performance
Regulatory	relatively satisfactory: order, democracy, secularism, unity, law and order
Impartial rule of law	hit by class bias, corruption, political interference
Developmental	mixed
Facilitation (post-1991)	doer → facilitator for private sector, NGOs, local bodies; ***particularly weak***

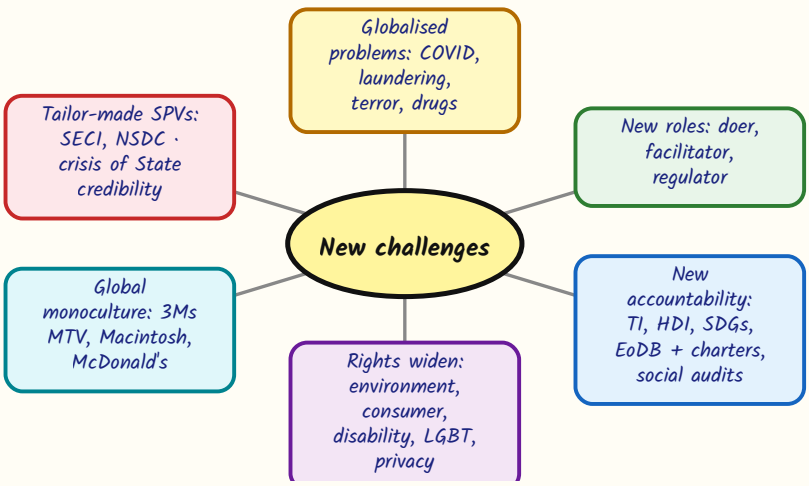
WHY PERFORMANCE SUFFERS

Causes

→ political interference; ***dual control*** over AIS
→ reluctance to use constitutional protection (cost)
→ ***arbitrary transfers, short tenures*** (DC about 1 year)
→ ***street-level bureaucracy*** corruption
→ poor capacity building; ***wage compression***; weak evaluation; little people's participation

WILD SCARE — **W**age compression · **I**nterference · **L**ack of participation · **D**ual control · **S**treet-level corruption · **C**apacity · **A**rbitrary transfers · **R**eluctance to use protection · **E**valuation poor (own mnemonic)

21st-CENTURY CHALLENGES



Reforms must be ***continuous, not episodic***; professionalism is the aim. ***PYQ printed here: 2014 cadre-based services*** → Ch 2.

In the news · Saarthi IAS CA, Aug 2026 (verify) ***Cabinet Secretary:*** ACC approved a one-year extension.
Link: stable tenure at the top vs arbitrary transfers lower down (T.S.R. Subramanian).

Recall drill: cover and answer

Four functions	formulate, implement, evaluate, adjudicate
Evaluation problem	conflict of interest → social audit
Weakest performance area	facilitation (post-1991)
Average DC tenure	about one year
3Ms of monoculture	MTV, Macintosh, McDonald's

BUREAUCRACY & DEVELOPMENT

PYQ none quoted in the material · Handout MI pp. 13-15

✎ *Weber said bureaucracy is like fire: a fine servant, a terrible master. Democracy both needs it and fears it, and Indian bureaucracy has its own habits and paradoxes.*

> **Max Weber:** *"Democracy has to promote what reason demands but what democratic sentiments hate." A* **love-hate** *relationship: bureaucracy is like* **fire**, *invaluable servant, destructive master.*

Promotes democracy

- → institutionalises rule of law
- → free and fair elections
- → fulfils the six role expectations
- → balances policymaking
- → delivers socio-economic justice

Threatens it

- → instrument → institution; resists reform
- → oligarchic power; ***secrecy*** (uninformed parliament)
- → suppresses NGOs, pressure groups, local bodies
- → not a ***representative bureaucracy*** (class, caste, religion, occupation)
- → corruption; ***state oppression*** (ED, CBI against rivals)
- → power struggle → ***politico-administrative no-man's land***

SCORPIOS — Bureaucracy as master stings: **S**ecrecy · **C**orruption · **O**ligarchy · **R**epresentation absent · **P**olitico-admin no-man's land · **I**nstrument→institution · **O**ppression · **S**uppresses NGOs (own mnemonic)

Political-bureaucratic conflict	Parties
Mundhra scandal 1957	LIC investments in Haridas Mundhra firms; FM and Finance Secretary resigned
Mid-1960s	Home Minister Nanda vs Home Secretary L.P. Singh
1973	Railway Minister Hanumanthaiah vs Railway Board Chairman B.C. Ganguli
1987	PM Rajiv Gandhi vs Foreign Secretary A.P. Venkateswaran (Sri Lanka)

WEBER vs DEVELOPMENT ADMINISTRATION

Weber's bureaucracy	Development administration
division of labour, specialisation	***change*** orientation
clear hierarchy	***result*** orientation (quantified)
rule orientation (impartial)	***commitment*** to change; time-bound
role specificity (accountability)	***client*** orientation; participation

C R C C — Development admin = **C**hange · **R**esults · **C**ommitment (time-bound) · **C**lients. (own mnemonic)

Conflicts: goal displacement · low adaptability (built to hold status quo) · historical mismatch (development admin emerged after WW II) · society must be ready · excess formalism, unsuited to rural development. Bureaucracy can exist in private bodies too.

INDIAN BUREAUCRACY

Structural

→ British pattern
→ long hierarchies
→ centralised, cadre-based
→ ***unstable tenure*** ("packing and unpacking")
→ standard departmental structure

Behavioural

→ colonial mindset: master not servant
→ non-responsive; ***Hakim culture***
→ ***Babu culture:*** file and rule fetishism, creative inertia
→ corruption, red tape, secrecy

Paradoxes

→ advanced technology amid backwardness
→ govt spends on itself: ***16 paise*** of each rupee reaches people (Rajiv Gandhi)
→ archaic values; authority-responsibility mismatch
→ unstable tenure; weak inter-agency coordination
→ ***learning disorders*** (e.g. repeated dengue in Delhi)
→ generalists preferred; wage compression

Recall drill: cover and answer

Weber's metaphor	bureaucracy is like fire: servant or master
Mundhra scandal	1957, LIC; FM and Finance Secretary resigned
Development admin traits	change, results, commitment, clients
Hakim vs Babu	colonial master mindset vs file/rule fetishism
Rajiv Gandhi figure	16 paise of a rupee reaches people

PAY, 8th CPC & RIGHT TO STRIKE

PYQ none quoted in the material · Handout MI pp. 16-17

✎ *Civil servants earn less than the private sector but get security, perks and status. The 8th Pay Commission is about a multiplier, and strikes in essential services are a public-interest line.*

Salaries are often lower than the private sector, but with ***job security, fringe benefits, higher status and public service***. Balance = ***performance-linked incentives***.

8th CENTRAL PAY COMMISSION

FORMULA — ***Revised Basic Pay = Existing Basic Pay × Fitment Factor*** · reference date ***1 Jan 2026*** · higher factor → higher allowances and pension liability.

Issues

→ ***minimum-wage model*** (3 consumption units; demand to add dependent parents)
→ ***DA merger*** demand; DA is absorbed then reset = inflation compensation
→ fiscal impact: committed spending, less capex
→ pressure on states to follow

Way forward

→ regular smaller revisions
→ performance orientation without hurting neutrality
→ workforce rationalisation; digital governance
→ link to inflation, revenue, fiscal capacity

RIGHT TO STRIKE

Trigger: Essential Defence Services Bill, 2021: bans strikes in essential defence services incl. ordnance factories (***41 factories, ~84,000 workers***) for uninterrupted supply in a two-front conflict.

In favour	*Against*
collective protest by citizens	public interest: strike = loaded gun at citizens
protection from exploitation	civil servants = model citizens
last resort when other means fail	govt must treat staff fairly

Balanced position (handout): no strikes that seriously disrupt essential public services; distinguish essential from non-essential services.

Legal position

→ strike misconduct = disciplinary offence under service rules and ***ESMA***
→ ***1st ARC (1966):*** oppose right to strike; unlawful strikes a ***penal offence***
→ ***Supreme Court:*** no fundamental, statutory or equitable right to strike

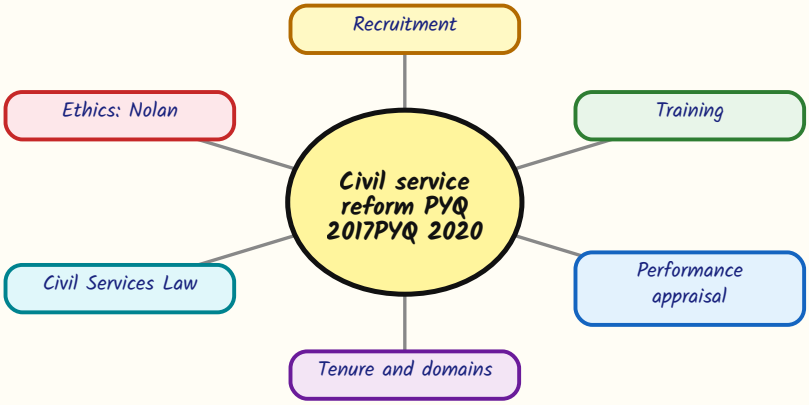
Recall drill: cover and answer

8th CPC formula	Existing basic pay × fitment factor
8th CPC reference date	1 January 2026
Essential Defence Services Bill	2021; 41 factories, ~84,000 workers
1st ARC on strikes	oppose; make unlawful strikes penal
SC on strikes	no fundamental, statutory or equitable right

CIVIL SERVICES REFORMS & NOLAN PRINCIPLES

PYQ Mains 2017 (neutrality and effectiveness) · 2020 (institutions and economic performance) · Handout MI pp. 17-18

✎ *Reform has four fronts: recruit better, train everyone, appraise on results, and write a Civil Services Law. Nolan's seven principles are the ethical yardstick.*



Recruitment

→ ***mainstream lateral entry***; less dependence on cadre services
→ ***Satish Chandra Committee***: separate exams for technical services
→ ***NIPAs (2nd ARC)***: after higher secondary, compete like IIT/AIIMS; ***3-4 years*** of public administration; graduates via ***1-year bridge course***
→ ***psycho-social profile***, SSB-style interview; probation to weed out

Training

→ for ***all***, not only Group A, B; mid-career training
→ fix content (unsuited to field; seen as paid holiday)
→ link training grades to promotion; soft skills

Appraisal

→ ***0-10 grades*** tied to targets
→ ***360-degree***: superiors, colleagues, juniors, clients; used for AIS empanelment for central deputation; 2nd ARC reservations: victimisation of honest officers

Tenure, law, specialists

→ stable tenure; ***domainisation*** (security, infrastructure, agriculture)
→ performance-linked incentives; ***remove deadwood*** by premature retirement
→ ***Civil Services Law*** (2nd ARC drafted a bill); transparent transfers, postings, discipline
→ ***rehabilitate specialists*** working under generalists on lower pay

NOLAN PRINCIPLES (1995)

Principle	Meaning
Selflessness	act only in public interest; no personal gain
Integrity	moral uprightness; avoid conflict of interest
Objectivity	merit and evidence; no bias
Accountability	answerable to public and oversight bodies
Openness	transparent; information accessible unless restricted by law
Honesty	truthful in declarations and dealings
Leadership	exemplify and promote these

HALO iOS — Nolan's seven: **H**onesty · **A**ccountability · **L**eadership · **O**penness · **I**ntegrity · **O**bjectivity · **S**elflessness. Handout order S-I-O-A-O-H-L. (own mnemonic)

PYQs printed: 2017 (250 w) CS designed for neutrality and effectiveness, now lacking; drastic reforms? · 2020 (150 w) institutional quality drives economic performance; suggest CS reforms to strengthen democracy.

In the news · Saarthi IAS CA, Aug and Jul 2026 (verify) ***Conflict of interest:*** National Horticulture Board bars public functionaries from commercial horticulture subsidies; ***SEBI*** rules (Sinha Committee): life-cycle disclosure, ***2-year cooling-off***, recusal, Office of Ethics and Compliance. Quote: Caesar's wife, trusteeship.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Nolan principles	selflessness, integrity, objectivity, accountability, openness, honesty, leadership
NIPA idea (2nd ARC)	after higher secondary; 3-4 years; 1-year bridge course
360-degree concern	victimisation of honest officers
Appraisal scale	0-10 grades tied to targets
Satish Chandra Committee	separate exams for technical services

REFORM CHALLENGES · MISSION KARMAYOGI · AARAMBH

PYQ Mains 2020 (institutions and economic performance) · Handout MI pp. 19-20

✎ *Reforms stall for human reasons. Mission Karmayogi tries to move the civil service from rules to roles with online, role-specific training.*

Why reforms stall

→ ***political will*** shifts; leaders resist losing control over transfers
→ ***management capacity*** weak; ***fragmented, piecemeal*** efforts
→ ***civil servants*** resist (job security, no incentive)
→ ***safety nets:*** compensation, retraining, counselling
→ ***context:*** one state's success may not suit another
→ ***communication*** and stakeholder engagement

CRAMPS — **C**ommunication · **R**esistance · **A**lignment with context · **M**anagement capacity · **P**olitical will · **S**afety nets (own mnemonic)

Way forward: cross-party commitment · reform units (capacity) · incentives for civil servants · safety nets · contextualise · institutionalise consultation and feedback.

MISSION KARMAYOGI (NPCSCB), 2020 PYQ 2020

Core shift: rules-based → roles-based HR. Aims: future-ready workforce · competency-driven specialist governance · align with ***Viksit Bharat 2047*** · performance-based appraisal over tenure-based promotion.

Component	What it does
iGOT Karmayogi	Integrated Government Online Training: on-demand, role-specific, blended, AI-personalised; unified across services, ministries, states
Competency frameworks	behavioural, functional, domain dictionaries; replace one-size-fits-all
Performance management	outcome-based; beyond Annual Confidential Reports to real-time feedback; links to promotion, posting, recognition
SPV: Karmayogi Bharat	not-for-profit company; content, partnerships, implementation
Capacity Building Commission	custodian of the framework

I C P S — Karmayogi: **i**GOT · **C**ompetency · **P**erformance · **S**PV (+ the Commission). (own mnemonic)

Implementation problems

→ integrating lateral entrants (culture gap)
→ compliance → problem-solving mindset
→ Centre-State coordination
→ digital infrastructure in remote areas

Significance

→ efficiency, transparency, accountability
→ responsive governance
→ control-focused → role-based, citizen-first

Aarambh: Common Foundation Course for probationers; stresses ***Commitment, Character, Conduct.***

In the news · Saarthi IAS CA, Jul 2026 (verify) ***DAKSH Leadership Programme*** (3rd batch): senior PSE executives; run by the Capacity Building Commission and SCOPE with ISB.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Mission Karmayogi shift	rules-based → roles-based
iGOT stands for	Integrated Government Online Training
SPV	Karmayogi Bharat, not-for-profit
Aarambh stresses	Commitment, Character, Conduct
Karmayogi aligns with	Viksit Bharat 2047

TRANSPARENCY & NDSAP

PYQ none quoted in the material · Handout MI pp. 21-23

✎ *Transparency means the rules, reasons and records of power are open to the people. It comes first; accountability and integrity follow. NDSAP opens government data.*

OECD: objectives, frameworks, decisions and reasons made comprehensible, accessible, timely.

UNESCAP: decisions follow rules; information freely and directly accessible to those affected.

TOP — Three metaphors: **T**ool of good governance · **O**pen decision-making (secrecy vs privacy) · **P**ublic value (counters corruption). (own mnemonic)

ACE TIPS — Objectives: **A**ccountability · **C**ombat corruption · **E**ntitlements · **T**rust · **I**nformed citizens · **P**articipation · **S**ervice delivery (own mnemonic)

Transparency is the precursor of accountability, integrity and probity. Mechanisms: RTI, e-governance, Citizen's Charters. Key measures: ***RTI 2005, NDSAP 2012, Charters, e-governance, CPGRAMS.***

SOCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY TOOLS

Tool / practice	Impact
Social audits, ***MGNREGA, Rajasthan***	villagers found ghost beneficiaries, wage leakages
Citizen Report Cards, Bengaluru	feedback improved electricity, water
Public Expenditure Tracking, ***Uganda***	less diversion of education grants
EDUCO, El Salvador	community school management improved teacher accountability

E-governance

→ streamlines, cuts discretion

→ limits: digital divide, privacy, cybersecurity, low literacy

Challenges of transparency

→ burden from non-serious applications

→ misuse by anti-social elements

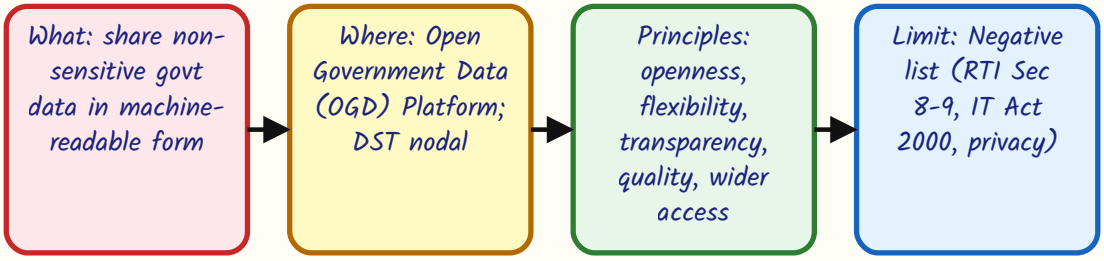
→ authenticity; wrong interpretation

→ privacy and confidentiality

Committee / report	Recommendation
2nd ARC, 14th Report	mandatory proactive disclosure; e-governance with service delivery; public data portals
Law Commission 179th, 255th	redefine RTI exemptions; guide on public-interest disclosure
NCRWC	replace Official Secrets Act with proper national-security law
CIC 2013	political parties come within RTI; non-compliance persists

NDSAP 2012

FOUR LINES ON NDSAP



Transparency vs privacy: RTI may clash with the Official Secrets Act, Conduct Rules, privacy. ***Sec 8(2)***: disclose when public interest outweighs protected interest. Aadhaar and DBT need strong data protection. Digital and language barriers exclude the marginalised.

Recall drill: cover and answer

NDSAP year, nodal dept	2012; DST
Platform	Open Government Data (OGD)
Negative list based on	RTI Sec 8-9, IT Act 2000, privacy
Transparency is precursor of	accountability, integrity, probity
Rajasthan social audit	MGNREGA; ghost beneficiaries

ACCOUNTABILITY

PYQ Mains 2018* (effectiveness of government and people's participation) · Handout MI pp. 24-28

✎ *Accountability = answering for your actions and facing a penalty if you fail. It runs up, down and sideways, and every answer should ask: for what, to whom, through what?*

Responsibility = duty to carry out assigned tasks. ***Accountability*** = responsibility working through hierarchy: ***answerability*** (give account) + ***enforceability*** (penalty).

EAR — Components: **E**nforcement · **A**nswerability · **R**esponsiveness. (own mnemonic)

CHAI — Dimensions: **C**ontrolling political power · **H**uman · **A**rgumentative · **I**nformational. (own mnemonic)

Values and objectives

→ ***values:*** integrity, impartiality, objectivity, empathy, compassion

→ ***objectives:*** control abuse · set standards · continuous improvement · link administration with democracy · institutional introspection

TYPES OF ACCOUNTABILITY

Type	Meaning
Managerial	within hierarchy
Political	civil servants → ministers → legislature
Judicial	unconstitutional or illegal acts
Institutional / Horizontal	external bodies: CAG, CBI, CVC
Professional	Bar Council, ICAI codes
Social	citizens: RTI, charters, social audit, Lokpal

THREE DIRECTIONS

Horizontal: state bodies seek answers and punish (CAG, EC, CVC, CIC, ombudsman) → *Vertical: citizens and civil society (elections, lobbying, report cards, social audit)* → *Diagonal: citizens approach horizontal bodies directly = PIL*

Other classifications

→ ***Financial/fiscal:*** oldest; legislature controls public purse (World Bank: accounting, external audit, follow-up)

→ ***Process*** (tenders, contracts); ***Programme*** (results: right beneficiaries?)

→ ***Intra***-organisational (inside) vs ***extra***-organisational (outside)

→ ***World Bank: micro***-accountability (to service users) and ***macro*** (financial, economic performance)

Need: bigger government · delegated legislation · politics-bureaucracy nexus · corruption · limited participation. ***Three questions: for what, to whom, through what.*** Tools: traditional (ministerial control, debates, committees, media, ombudsman) + ***New Public Management*** (efficiency, outcomes, competition, value for money).

MECHANISMS

Institutions

→ ***CVC***: Feb 1964, Santhanam Committee; statutory 2003
→ ***Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act 2013***: committee = PM, LS Speaker, LoP (LS), CJI or nominee, eminent jurist
→ ***Whistle Blowers Protection Act 2014***: no anonymous complaints
→ ***CAG***: guardian of the public purse; reports to Parliament and PAC
→ ***social audit, RTI, Citizens' Charters***

Modern

→ performance audits, outcome budgeting
→ ***Social Audit 2.0*** (digital dashboards); ethics committees
→ data-driven vigilance cells; ***CPGRAMS, PRAGATI***

Issues

→ unclear relationships; size of govt
→ secrecy; excess focus on inputs
→ top-down enforcement
→ ***new***: AI bias; platform governance; ***PPPs diffuse blame***

Solutions

→ decentralise (World Bank)
→ ***bottom-up*** accountability
→ value-driven; ethical capacity building
→ internalise it beyond fear of sanction; tech with human oversight

Handout flag: the CVC and Lokpal selection committees are different. CVC: ***PM, Home Minister, LoP***. Lokpal: ***PM, Speaker, LoP, CJI/nominee, jurist***.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Two parts of accountability	answerability + enforceability
Horizontal / vertical / diagonal	state bodies / citizens / citizens → bodies (PIL)
Micro vs macro	service users vs financial and economic performance
CVC set up	Feb 1964, Santhanam; statutory 2003
Three questions	for what, to whom, through what

CITIZEN'S CHARTER & SEVOTTAM

PYQ Mains 2024 (15 m) · 2018 (15 m) · 2013 (10 m) · Handout MI pp. 28–31

✎ *A Charter is the office's promise to citizens: what service, how fast, whom to complain to. It creates no new right. Sevottam is the quality system that tries to make the promise real.*

Launched 1991 by John Major (UK). Declaration of commitment on ***qualitative and temporal entitlements***; ***creates no new rights***, seeks to enforce existing ones; includes grievance redress.

Purposes

- → clarifies expectations; responsive govt; service mindset
- → ***people's participation*** (consultation)
- → ***strengthens accountability*** (standards + timelines separate performers)
- → good-governance signal; credibility; empowerment

Elements (India)

- → vision and mission; business transacted; clients served
- → services per client group
- → ***grievance redressal and how to reach it***
- → what is expected of clients (documents, fees)
- → ***compensation*** details; internal + external monitoring

By 2011-end: ***131*** central and ***729*** state charters · site ***goicharters.nic.in***.

PROBLEMS PYQ 2024 PYQ 2018 PYQ 2013

Why charters fail

- → bureaucratic mindset; ***manager's charter*** (little consultation)
- → ***no penal provisions***; low awareness
- → standards too lax or too strict; too detailed or too brief
- → redressal names and addresses missing
- → no incentives (UK ***Charter Mark***; DARPG hired an outside agency)
- → brochures treated as charters; elderly and disabled ignored
- → poor review; no devolution to street-level staff; jargon, no vernacular; one format for all

WHO CARE — ARC-II fixes: **W**idest consultation · **H**old officers accountable (penal) · **O**ne size does not fit all · **C**ommit to what you can deliver · **A**ppropriate redressal · **R**eform internal processes · **E**valuate with user feedback (own mnemonic)

Suggestions: DARPG hand-holding for first charters · credible NGOs for awareness · user groups and staff in drafting · outside monitoring · prioritise services · incentives (organisation and individual) · best-practice showcase · simple language · ***5-year master plan with budget***.

SEVOTTAM = SEVA + UTTAM

SEVOTTAM IN FOUR STEPS

2nd ARC idea; launched 2006 → Piloted in 10 departments (2009-10) → IS 15700:2005 (BIS) certifies the Sevottam symbol → Three modules: Charter · Grievances · Service delivery capability

Core module	Focus
Citizen Charter implementation	feedback shapes service norms
Public grievance redressal	responsive, empathetic redress regardless of outcome
Service delivery capability	internal processes, resources, workforce

D S D P M E I — Seven steps in order: **D**efine services · **S**et standards · **D**evelop capability · **P**erform · **M**onitor · **E**valuate impact · **I**mprove. Remember: Do Something Daily; People Must Expect Improvement. (own mnemonic)

Significance: structured quality management (2025 DARPG workshop, Bhopal) · citizen-centric culture · credible self-assessment.

Challenges: procedural compliance · fragmented adoption · weak digital link. ***Way:*** training; link with CPGRAMS, MyGov, dashboards; third-party audit.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Charter origin	1991, John Major, UK
Does a Charter create rights?	No; enforces existing ones
Charters by 2011	131 central, 729 state
Sevottam launch; standard	2006; IS 15700:2005
Three Sevottam modules	Charter, grievances, service delivery capability

RTI ACT 2005 & THE 2019 AMENDMENT

PYQ Mains 2020 (RTI amendments and autonomy of Information Commission) · Handout MI pp. 31–35

✎ *RTI turns a citizen's question into a legal duty on any public authority. Few exemptions, a public-interest override and penalties: the 2019 amendment moved tenure and pay of Commissioners to the Centre.*

1766 — Sweden: first RTI law

1966 — USA second

Ombudsman: Sweden 1809; India's central ombudsman **2013** (per Module 1).

Constitutional locus: not codified directly; Preamble supports; **SC read it into Art 19(1)(a), Art 21, Art 39(b), 39(c)**. Cases: **Rajnarain 1975, S.P. Gupta 1982**. Madison: popular government without information is "a Prologue to a Farce or a Tragedy".

Why demand grew

→ spread of democracy; World Bank, IMF, TI advocacy
→ **NCPRI 1996 (Aruna Roy)**, PUCL, ADR
→ **MKSS**, Janawad, Rajasthan: "**Humara Paisa, Humara Hisab**"

MONOPOLY — **Monopoly + Discretion − Transparency = Corruption.** RTI: corrects power asymmetry, realises other rights (food), trust deficit (info within **30 days**), better records, shields civil servants (documentary proof).

1997 — Shourie working group; **Tamil Nadu** acts first

2002 — Freedom of Information Bill (weak, not notified)

2005 — RTI Act: drafted by **National Advisory Council**

PAID — A sound regime: **P**enalties (Rs 250 a day, max Rs 25,000) · **A**ccess (low fees, free for BPL) · **I**ndependent appeal (CIC, SIC) · **D**isclosure maximum, exemption minimum (own mnemonic)

MAIN FEATURES

Right and scope

→ every citizen; wide definition of information (records, memos, e-mail, advice, orders, contracts, samples, electronic data, private-body info held by an authority)
→ includes inspection, certified copies, samples, electronic formats
→ **public authority:** constitutional or statutory bodies; owned, controlled or **substantially financed** (undefined); NGOs substantially financed

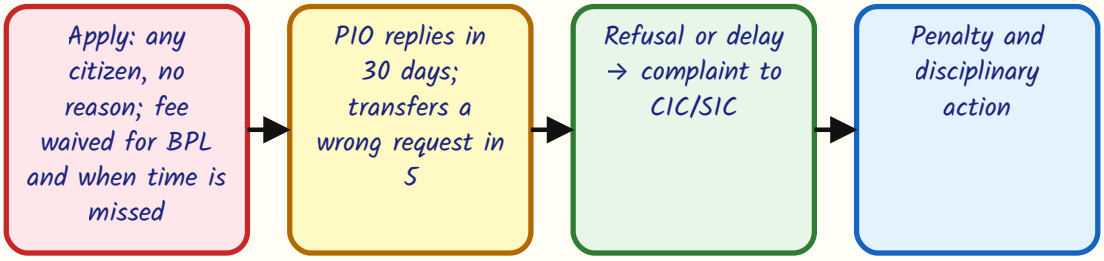
Contested body	Handout position
President / Governors	long-pending question
BCCI / federations	substantially financed; **CIC affirmed 2018**
PPP projects	DoPT circular 2013; DIAL: CIC 2010 yes, Delhi HC stayed
Judiciary	**SC 2019:** by and large covered
Political parties	**CIC 2013:** recognised parties are public authorities

SC puzzles in handout: RBI must disclose banks' info, yet 2019: risk and inspection reports need not be; "fear psychosis and paralysis" remark; objections to parties: free associations, no direct tax money.

PROCEDURE: THE NUMBERS

16-120-100-5-10-20 — **16** types of suo motu info in **120** days · designate PIOs in **100** days · transfer in **5** · third party **10** days · release after **20** years. Reply **30 days**. Penalty **Rs 250/day, up to Rs 25,000**.

PATH OF A REQUEST



EXEMPTIONS (Sec 8) AND OVERRIDE

Exempt

→ sovereignty, security, strategic, scientific, economic interests; foreign relations; incitement
→ court-forbidden; contempt; legislative privilege
→ trade secrets, IP (unless larger public interest); fiduciary; foreign confidences
→ safety, sources; impeding investigation
→ ***Cabinet papers*** (public after completion); personal information unrelated to public activity

Public-interest override over the Official Secrets Act 1923. ***Only absolute exemption: copyright of a person other than the State.*** What cannot be denied to Parliament cannot be denied to citizens.

Second Schedule: intelligence and security bodies exempt, but ***corruption and human-rights*** info must be given (rights: with Commission's approval). CBI and NIA added by executive order. Act overrides OSA; ***courts barred*** except appeals; ***wholly retrospective***; exempt info released after ***20 years*** (not Cabinet, privilege, sovereignty etc.).

RIGHTS AND THE 2019 AMENDMENT PYQ 2020

Rights: medium and language of choice · help in writing · no reason needed · notice of transfer · help for the disabled · fee waived (BPL, delay) · reasons for rejection and appeal details · complaint for no PIO, refusal, delay, unreasonable fee, incomplete or false info.

2019 change	Effect
Tenure and appointment	Centre decides; 5-year term removed
Salary and service	Centre fixes; delinked from CEC and ECs
Status	CIC clarified as ***statutory, not constitutional***

Negative: executive overreach · public distrust · federal dilution (SICs).

Positive: flexibility · fiscal discipline · policy alignment. ***Reflect:*** efficiency vs independence.

In the news · Saarthi IAS CA, Aug 2026 (verify) ***NSE and RTI:*** SC stayed a Delhi HC order that held NSE a public authority. ***Hook:*** "substantially financed" is undefined (BCCI, parties, DIAL).

Recall drill: cover and answer

First RTI law	Sweden 1766; USA 1966
Constitutional articles	19(1)(a), 21, 39(b), 39(c)
Who drafted 2005 bill	National Advisory Council
Absolute exemption	copyright of a non-State person
2019 Amendment effect	Centre fixes tenure and pay; CIC statutory

CIC · RTI ISSUES · IMPACT · 2nd ARC

PYQ Mains 2020 (RTI amendment and independence of Commission) · Handout MI pp. 36-38

✎ *The CIC is the RTI's appeal body. Its biggest problems are pendency, weak penalties and awareness. The 2nd ARC gave a fix for each.*

CENTRAL INFORMATION COMMISSION

1+10 · 3/65 · 5 — **1 CIC + up to 10 ICs** · term **3 years or age 65**, earlier one · no reappointment · IC elevated to CIC: total **max 5 years**.

Appointment

→ by the **President** on a committee: **PM (Chair), Leader of Opposition (LS), a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by PM**
→ eminent in law, science, social service, journalism, media, administration
→ no office of profit, party link, business

Pay (Rules 2019): delinked from CEC/EC parity · **CIC Rs 2,50,000, IC Rs 2,25,000** a month.

Removal

→ **proved misbehaviour or incapacity** after **Supreme Court inquiry** (President's reference)
→ without SC inquiry: insolvency · moral turpitude conviction · paid job · unfit in body or mind · prejudicial financial interest

BICEP — Without SC inquiry: **B**ankrupt · **I**nfirm · **C**onvicted (moral turpitude) · **E**mployed (paid) · **P**rejudicial financial interest. (own mnemonic)

ISSUES AND CHALLENGES

Gaps

→ RTI is a means; access is the end
→ bureaucratic mindset; **no specific budget** (2nd ARC: 1% of flagship funds)
→ low awareness (APWC: 12% women, 26% men, 13% rural, 33% urban)
→ ICs mostly **retired bureaucrats**; vague terms

Enforcement

→ **penalty not imposed in 95%** of due cases (Satark Nagrik Sangathan)
→ no organic CIC-SIC link; juniors made PIOs without incentive
→ poor record keeping; **abuse of Schedule II**
→ IC orders unimplemented: no contempt powers

Pendency

→ **40-60 lakh** requests a year
→ **2.55 lakh** pending in 26 ICs; vacancies; disposal **1 yr 11 months**; COVID worsened
→ **21 of 29** ICs filed no 2019-20 report; AP, Telangana none since 2017; Odisha since 2015-16
→ media and activists less interested

Impact: also a grievance tool · exposed corruption, scams, recruitment marks · rural access via NGOs · aided Right to Food and Education · works for **personally relevant** info, less for controversial public-interest info.

2nd ARC RECOMMENDATIONS

Secrecy

→ ***repeal Official Secrets Act***
→ oath of secrecy → ***oath of transparency***
→ review Second Schedule
→ ***Public Records Act 1993:*** 5-year declassification review

Classification	Damage
Top Secret	exceptionally grave
Secret	serious
Confidential	simple
Restricted	official use only

Structure and access

→ selection: ***CJI replaces Cabinet Minister***; at least half of ICs from non-civil-service background
→ 4 regional CIC offices; nodal PIO; PIOs at least ***Deputy Secretary/Director***
→ payment by stamps, postal orders; district single-window; free print suo motu
→ independent public records office; ***1% of flagship funds for 5 years***; training beyond PIOs; NGOs for awareness
→ ***"substantially financed" = 50% of operating costs for 3 years or at least Rs 1 crore***; check frivolous complaints

Recall drill: cover and answer

CIC strength	1 CIC + up to 10 ICs
Term and age	3 years or 65
CIC / IC pay	Rs 2.5 lakh / Rs 2.25 lakh
Penalty gap	not imposed in 95% of due cases
2nd ARC definition	substantially financed = 50% operating cost 3 yrs or Rs 1 crore

THE PROBLEM OF CORRUPTION

PYQ Mains 2016 · 2019 · 2014 · Handout M2 · Corruption

✎ *Corruption is misuse of public power for private gain. Learn the types, why it happens, what it costs and how it is measured, each with an example.*

As old as civilisation: Kautilya's Arthashastra lists ways a civil servant can be corrupt and the checks. ***TI definition:*** private abuse of public office. ***Elephant Test:*** hard to define, yet society knows it.

Defining issues

→ ***Is a gift a bribe?*** intent · expectation · timing · value · law · social acceptance

→ ***Culture:*** old school ties (UK) · regulated lobbying (USA) · ***Blat*** (Russia) · ***Guanxi*** (China)

→ ***Public only or private too?*** wide net dilutes focus; clean government shrinks private corruption

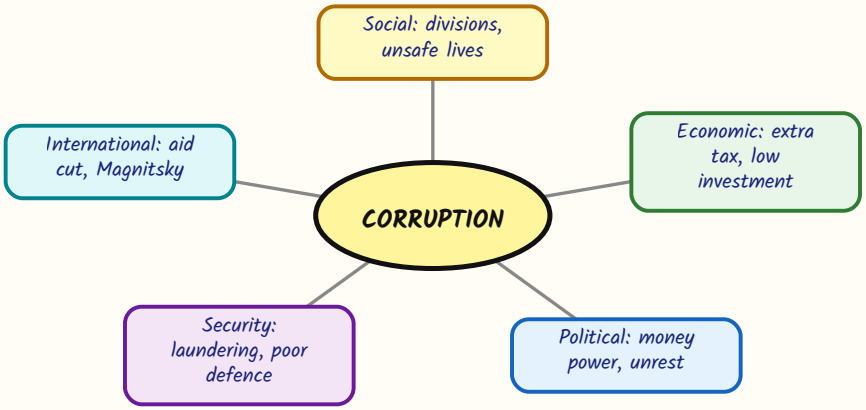
TYPES

Pair	Meaning
Black	whole society: intolerable
White	recognised yet tolerated (speed money)
Grey	society divided
Grass eating	will not seek, will not refuse
Meat eating	actively seeks
Coercive	official extorts the citizen
Collusive	both collude against public interest
Retail vs Policy	petty speed money vs state capture, crony capitalism

Behaviour that harms: lethargy · negligence · non-punctuality · subjective view of public interest · favouritism, nepotism · communalism, casteism, regional bias.

IMPLICATIONS PYQ 2016 PYQ 2019

FIVE FALLOUTS



Revisionism (minority view): some corruption speeds a lethargic, low-paid bureaucracy. Reject for equity and rule of law.

WHY IT HAPPENS

PEL-APS — **P**sycho-social · **E**conomic · **L**egal · **A**dministrative · **P**olitical · **S**ocial evils within (dowry, lavish weddings) (own mnemonic)

Psycho-social
- → need for ***THYMOS*** (respect); low self-worth; shaming of government staff
- → ***Squirrel Nuts Syndrome*** (near retirement); opportunity theory
- → no popular sanction; protestant areas less corrupt

Economic
- → poor pay at upper levels (pay alone not enough)
- → consumerism; ***licence-permit-quota raj → clearance raj***
- → MNCs bribing; firms outbidding each other

Legal
- → ***Art 311*** hard dismissal · ***PCA Sec 19*** sanction · ***CrPC Sec 197*** sanction (protect honest, misused)
- → delayed prosecution; no whistleblower law; weak CBI/CVC autonomy

THE SANCTION CHAIN

Single Directive: sanction for Joint Secretary and above → *Vineet Narain 1997: struck down* → *DSPE Sec 6A inserted* → *2014: Sec 6A struck down (equality)* → *PCA 2018, Sec 17A: permission for all except red-handed*

Administrative + Political
- → complex procedures breed middlemen; red tape; weak grievance machinery; politicised transfers; secrecy
- → no political will (Lokpal delays); criminalised politics; ***TINA***; election money; weak party-funding disclosure

MEASURING CORRUPTION

CPI — ***CPI*** by Transparency International · annual since ***1995*** · ***0 = most corrupt, 100 = cleanest.*** 2020 CPI: NZ and Denmark top; Somalia, South Sudan last; Bhutan 24, USA 25, Botswana 35, China 78, Pakistan 124 (as printed).

CPI critique: expert and business opinion · perception, not fact · sources change · country count varies, so ranks not comparable.

Other tools: Global Corruption Barometer (experience; India most corrupt of 17 Asian countries) · World Bank ***PETS*** · media content analysis · official data.

Recall drill: cover and answer

TI definition	private abuse of public office
Grass vs meat eating	accepts if offered vs actively seeks
Sanction chain	Single Directive → Narain → 6A → struck 2014 → 17A (2018)
CPI scale; since	0 corrupt to 100 clean; 1995
Mauro estimate	investment lower by up to 12%

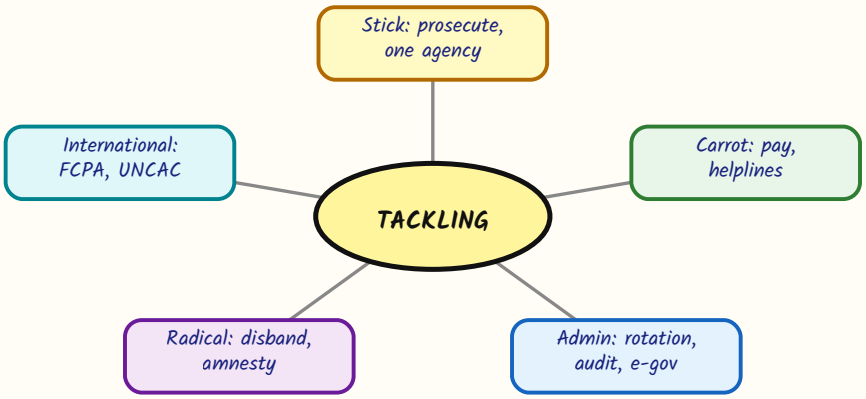
TACKLING CORRUPTION & SOCIAL AUDIT

PYQ Mains 2021 · 2016* · Handout M2 · Strategies

✎ *Corruption is a "wicked problem": it can be controlled, not removed. Use sticks, carrots, administrative fixes, radical ideas and citizen audit together.*

Wicked problem: PCA, Lokpal, CVC Act exist, yet corruption persists. More laws signal systemic inefficiency; aim to **control**, not eliminate.

TOOLKIT



SCARIER – **S**tick · **C**arrot · **A**dministrative · **R**adical · **I**nternational · **E**nforcement of social audit · **R**eports (CPI). (own mnemonic)

Stick

→ **Prosecution:** high conviction deters (Botswana); India: delays, light punishment; harsh China model needs rule of law
→ **Stings:** admissibility unclear; natural stings (citizen recordings) should count; Sweden strict
→ **Tighten laws** (2018 diluted PCA); **asset declaration** + lifestyle checks
→ **One strong agency:** Singapore **CPIB**, Hong Kong **ICAC** vs India's CVC, CBI, Lokpal, ED
→ **Shame/blacklist** (South Africa); **forfeit pensions**

Carrot

→ big pay rise + enforcement
→ **Delhi hotline** needs whistleblower and witness protection

Admin/tech

→ **Job rotation** (Kautilya)
→ **CAG** covers 25% of units yearly
→ Public Procurement Law (30% of GDP; **2012 bill lapsed**)
→ digitise; CCTV

Radical

→ **Disband** departments: Georgia traffic police 2004
→ **Gender balance**: Peru
→ **Monetise bribes**: Romania (controversial)
→ **Amnesty**: 50% surrender of black money (debated)

International: US **FCPA 1977** · UK **Bribery Act 2010** · **OECD Anti-Bribery 1997** · **UNCAC 2003** · **FATF 1989** · Interpol IGEC. **Critique:** West ignored corruption till 1990s; geopolitical tool; NGO vested interests; cultural imperialism. **Alternatives:** spiritual education; **Integrity Recognition Certificates** (keep apolitical).

SOCIAL AUDIT PYQ 2021

Definition: scheme details (finance and non-finance) shared on a public platform (**Jan Sunwai, Gram Sabha**), so people hold bureaucracy and Panchayat leaders accountable. **Key: sound access to information.**

Features
- → multi-perspective
- → regular
- → comparative
- → **strengthens demand side**

Significance
- → participation
- → benefits reach target
- → social capital
- → training needs
- → better programmes

Issues
- → outside mainstream policy; statutory in few schemes (**NREGA**)
- → few trained auditors; vested-interest opposition
- → **Symptom vs cause**: audit layers (plague drive without sanitation)

Strengthening
- → **Legal:** national law like **Meghalaya 2017**; independent units (**AP SSAAT**); support CAG and PRIs
- → Gram Sabha awareness; auditor training; NGO, media; recognition; portals; unified guidelines
- → **Chhattisgarh:** audit linked to redress, wall writing · **Karnataka:** rotate teams every **3 cycles**

Success story	Detail
AP MGNREGA (SSAAT)	autonomous, village resource persons, crores recovered, World Bank best practice
Jharkhand SAU	ghost beneficiaries exposed; **SC Swaraj Abhiyan 2016** appreciated
Rajasthan MKSS	jan sunwais → **RTI Act 2005**
Bengaluru CRCs	report cards: bribery down (2003)
Municipal benchmarking	compare cost per km of road

In the news · Saarthi IAS CA, Jul/Aug 2026 (verify) **Low Gram Sabha participation (NIRDPR study):** barriers: livelihood and time (55.5%), exclusion of migrants, women, youth, elderly; trust fatigue. **Impact:** elite capture; social audits become a formality; Niyamgiri 2013 (12 Gram Sabhas rejected mining). **Way:** Action Taken Reports; off-peak meetings; Kudumbashree; ARC-II statutory powers.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Sustained approach	control, not eliminate: wicked problem
Single-agency models	Singapore CPIB, Hong Kong ICAC
Meghalaya	first social audit Act (2017)
Karnataka best practice	rotate audit teams after 3 cycles
Key to social audit	access to information

CBI & CVC

PYQ Mains 2021* · Handout M2 · Institutions

✎ *CBI investigates, CVC watches. Vineet Narain (1997) put the CVC over the CBI and gave the Director a fixed tenure.*

Legal framework

→ ***DSPE Act 1946*** (CBI) · RPA 1951 Sec 123 · ***PCA 1988*** · Benami Act 1988 · ***PMLA 2003*** · CVC Act · RTI 2005 · Lokayuktas · Lokpal 2013 · Whistleblower 2014

→ BNS Sec 203 (IPC 169) and Sec 316 (IPC 409), as printed

→ ***Bodies:*** CBI, CVC, state ACBs, CAG, Lokayuktas, Lokpal, ***ED*** (PMLA, FEMA), ombudsman, courts

CBI

HOW CBI GREW

Special Police Establishment, 1941 → DSPE Act 1946: statutory backing → Named CBI, 1963

Divisions: Anti-Corruption · Special Crimes · Economic Offences · Banking and Security Frauds.

Issues

→ "***Caged parrot***" politicisation; one-third posts vacant

→ ***conviction 67%*** vs 30–40% others; low in high-profile cases

→ sanction delays (PCA 19, CrPC 197)

→ ***no suo motu jurisdiction***

VINEET NARAIN 1997

SCATTER – ***S***ingle Directive struck · ***C***VC superintends CBI · ***A***ppoint Director by committee (PM, LoP, CJI) · ***T***enure 2 years · ***T***ransfer by same committee · ***E***xecutive (DoPT) sets only policy · ***R***ecommendations binding on process. (own mnemonic)

Later: Director tenure extendable up to ***5 years in yearly steps*** by ordinance.

CVC

CVC TIMELINE

1962 Santhanam Committee → 1964 executive body → 2003 CVC Act: statutory

1+2 · 4 · 65 – ***1 Commissioner + up to 2 Vigilance Commissioners*** · term ***4 years*** · age ***65*** · no reappointment.

Selection

→ All India/Central Services and CPSU officers (at least one from each)

→ committee: ***PM, Home Minister, Leader of Opposition***

→ ***P.J. Thomas 2011:*** consensus, not majority

Terms

→ pay: CVC = UPSC Chairperson; VC = UPSC member; Consolidated Fund
→ barred from UT administrator, diplomatic posts, office of profit
→ removal: misbehaviour on ***SC reference***; plus insolvency, turpitude, private job, infirmity, financial interest

Functions

→ superintend CBI on corruption cases; inquire on Central reference or complaints against ***Group A, AIS and equivalent CPSU***
→ review DSPE probes and sanctions; vigilance in ministries; ***civil-court powers***
→ chairs committees for ***ED Director*** and ***CBI SP-and-above*** (not Director)
→ annual report to President, laid before Parliament

Issues: depends on politicised CBI · no own prosecution · sanction delays · poor civil-society engagement.

Suggestions: functional autonomy (ARC-II) · ***3-6 month*** sanction deadline (TI India: 70%+ pending >6 months, 2023) · binding recommendations · manpower (<50% sanctioned) · civil-society role (Korea ACRC) · wider panel.

Flag: CVC Selection Committee (PM, HM, LoP) differs from Lokpal (PM, Speaker, LoP, CJI, jurist).

Recall drill: cover and answer

CBI timeline	1941 SPE → 1946 Act → 1963 named CBI
CVC statutory	2003
Director committee	PM, LoP, CJI
CVC term; age	4 years; 65
Thomas case 2011	selection by consensus

LOKPAL IN INDIA

PYQ Mains 2013 · Handout M2 · Lokpal

✎ *The Lokpal is the ombudsman for central corruption cases. The Act is detailed, but the body has been slow and thinly used.*

1809	1967	1968	1971	2013	2019
Sweden ombudsman	UK Parliamentary Commissioner	India's first bill	Maharashtra Lokayukta	Lokpal Act	Lokpal constituted: Justice P.C. Ghose

First ARC: two-tier: **Lokpal** (Secretary-rank and above, Union and State) and **Union Lokayukta** for lower officials; state Lokayuktas in states.

State experience

- → flooded complaints; weak effect; uneven powers
- → survives at government's will: **Odisha abolished 1992, Haryana 1999**
- → recommendatory "paper tigers"; misused against opponents

LOKPAL ACT 2013 PYQ 2013

9 · 25 · 45 · 5/70 — 9 members · **25** years' experience · min age **45** · term **5 years or 70**.

Composition

- → **Chairperson:** present or former CJI/SC judge or eminent person (25 yrs)
- → **8 members:** half judicial (SC judge/HC CJ), half non-judicial
- → **50% reserved:** SC, ST, OBC, minorities, women

Conditions

- → not MP/MLA/MLC; no local-body membership
- → not dismissed from service; no profit or business; no party

APPOINTMENT

Search committee of 7 shortlists (50% reserved) → *Selection committee: PM, Speaker, LoP, CJI or nominee, jurist* → *President appoints* → *No reappointment (except elevation within 5 years)*

Pay: Chairperson = CJI; member = SC judge. **Disabilities:** as CVC plus **no election for 5 years**. **Wings:** Inquiry (Director), Prosecution (Director), Secretary.

PRIME MINISTER: IN OR OUT?

2nd ARC (against): cripples administration; foreign exploit; PCA covers PM.

For: CBI under DoPT/PM; set example; some Lokayuktas cover CMs; **Art 361** exempts only President and Governors.

Act: PM covered, but not on **public order, internal and external security, atomic energy, space**; inquiry needs **two-thirds of full bench**.

JURISDICTION AND POWERS

Covers

→ PM, Union Ministers, MPs, ***Group A–D***, bodies funded above ***Rs 10 lakh*** a year
→ any individual may complain
→ Group C and D go to ***CVC***

FLOW OF A COMPLAINT

Preliminary inquiry (Inquiry Wing/CVC/CBI) in 60 days → *Hearing of public servant* → *Full investigation, departmental action, closure, or case against false complainant* → *Bench of 3+ decides sanction (replaces authority under CrPC 197, PCA 19)*

Powers: search, seizure, ***attachment***, civil-court powers, superintendence over CBI for referred cases. ***Removal:*** SC reference signed by ***100 MPs*** for misbehaviour; President for other grounds. Asset declarations; annual report; ***7-year limit*** on complaints.

ISSUES AND WAY FORWARD

Issues

→ wide jurisdiction; convoluted appointment; PM partly covered; 7-year limit; appointment delays
→ ***Since 2019:*** rules delayed, wings missing in 2020; 1,000 of 1,065 disposed (Sept 2019); complaints ***1,427 → 110 → 12*** (2019-20 → 2021-22 till Aug)

2nd ARC

→ ***constitutional status***
→ ***Rashtriya Lok Ayukta*** for Union ministers, MPs, CMs
→ State Lokayukta for state ministers/legislators
→ ***CVC*** for civil servants; ***Local Bodies Ombudsman***

Not a panacea: hydra-headed corruption; petty cases need departmental handling; weak judicial process; citizens unwilling to complain.

Recall drill: cover and answer

First bill; Act; constituted	1968; 2013; 2019
Members; term	9; 5 years or 70
Prelim inquiry	60 days
Removal reference	SC, signed by 100 MPs
Limit on complaints	7 years

WHISTLEBLOWERS & PCA 1988

PYQ Mains 2015 · 2022 · Handout M2 · Laws

✎ *The 2014 Act protects people who report corruption but bars anonymous complaints. The PCA 2018 amendment makes giving a bribe an offence too.*

WHISTLE BLOWERS PROTECTION ACT 2014

PIDPI: anyone, any public body. Disclosure to the ***competent authority***. ***No anonymous complaints***. ***Frivolous complaint: 2 years jail***. CVC can direct protection. ***2015 bill*** (lapsed): Official Secrets Act 1923 to override.

Complaint about	*Goes to*
Union ministers	***Prime Minister***
State ministers	***Chief Minister***
Legislators	***Presiding Officer***
Civil servants	***CVC***

Challenges

- → ***no anonymity***: ***Satyendra Dubey*** (NHAI) murdered
- → weak implementation, awareness, protection from victimisation
- → complaints rising: 2018 over 3,500 to NSE-listed firms

SAFE — Law Commission + 2nd ARC: **S**trong law (public + private) · **A**nonymity and confidentiality · **F**ear removed (protection from harm) · **E**ncouragement (***SEBI reward up to Rs 1 crore***). (own mnemonic)

PREVENTION OF CORRUPTION ACT 1988 PYQ 2015 PYQ 2022

"Public servant"

- → govt pay or service; PSU staff; local bodies; judges
- → govt-funded cooperatives; PSC members
- → central and state universities; ***deemed universities (SC 2020)***
- → anyone performing public duty, including MPs and MLAs

PCA AMENDMENT 2018

BRIBE 7/3-7 — **B**ribe-giving an offence · **R**eport in 7 days (coercive) · **I**nclusive of retired (17A) · **B**usiness bodies liable · **E**xpedited trial 2 yrs (max 4) · jail ***3 to 7 years***. (own mnemonic)

Change	*Detail*
Giving a bribe	now an offence; coercive case: report within ***7 days***
Sec 17A; 13(1)(d)	17A extended to ***retired*** servants; 13(1)(d) ***diluted***
Jail; trial	***3 to 7 years***; trial ***2 years, up to 4***
Commercial organisations	liable; ***attachment/confiscation***

Recall drill: cover and answer

Anonymous complaints	not entertained
Frivolous complaint	2 years jail
Satyendra Dubey	NHAI whistleblower, murdered
PCA 2018 jail; trial	3-7 years; 2 years (max 4)
Coercive bribe report	within 7 days